

The Coca-Cola Company

1Q25 First Impressions

KO just reported 1Q25 Comparable EPS of \$0.73 that bested us and Consensus at \$0.72 (reflecting a ~0.5c beat given rounding). Operating profit was nearly 2% ahead of our forecast, with partial offset from a ~0.5c drag below-the-line.

Our Thoughts

KO is surely one of the most owned names in our space and we think today's update will bolster this position, notwithstanding the 1% reduction in FXN EPS forecast for the year. To this point, tariffs were referenced in the release as being manageable and as we understand it, no pricing plans have yet been decided upon within the US System. Organic revenue growth was +6% but we think net of concentrate shipment timing was closer to the Street's 5% estimate. North America volume was softer than expected, as we worried could be the case given exposure to consumer boycotts, but this was comfortably made up for with stronger price/mix as has been the case over the past several quarters. Asia Pacific volumes were a particular standout with unit case volume +6% and reflecting strong activations in India and China.

Highlights

- Unit case volume +2% vs. our +0.5%
- APAC OSG +7% vs. our +3%
- Consolidated operating margin +130 bps vs. our +80 bps, though with some benefit from the timing of marketing investments
- Margin outperformance driven by BIG division (+205 bps vs. +65 bps)

Lowlights

- North America OSG +3% vs. our +3.5%, with UCV -3% vs. our flat
- Consolidated gross margin +30 bps vs. our +50 bps

2025 Guidance

Updated:

- Comparable constant currency EPS +7-9% (from +8-10%)
- FX headwind of 2-3% on net revenues (from 3-4% & vs. our -3.1% & Consensus -2.9%) and a 5-6% drag on comparable EPS (from 6-7% & vs. our -5.8%) based on current rates and including hedged positions
- Manageable tariff impact given operations are primarily local

Reiterated:

- Organic revenue +5-6% (vs. our +5.2% & Consensus at +5.6%)
- Comparable EPS +2-3% that implies \$2.94-\$2.97 (vs. our \$2.94 and Consensus \$2.96)
- Slight structural headwind on net revenues and comparable EPS
- Effective tax rate 20.8%, not including impact of ongoing tax litigation

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KO	OVERWEIGHT
U.S. CHPC & Beverages	NEUTRAL
Price Target	USD 73.00
Price (28-Apr-25)	USD 71.79
Potential Upside/Downside	+1.7%
Source: Bloomberg, Barclays Research	

U.S. CHPC & Beverages

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BCI, US

- Free cash flow of ~\$9.5 billion that excludes fairlife contingent consideration
- CFFO of \$11.7 billion, excluding fairlife payment
- Capex of \$2.2 billion

2Q25 Guidance

- FX headwind of 3% on net revenues (our -3.3%) and a 5-6% drag on comparable EPS based on current rates and including hedged positions

KO 1Q25 Earnings Call Details:

Today @ 8:30 AM ET - U.S. Dial: 1-888-415-4465; International: 1-646-960-0140; Passcode: 6819315.

As always, please feel free to call with any questions or comments.

Best,

Lauren

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The Coca-Cola Company (KO, 28-Apr-2025, USD 71.79), Overweight/Neutral, A/CD/CE/D/E/J/K/L/M/N

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Overweight - The stock is expected to outperform the unweighted expected total return of the industry coverage universe over a 12-month investment horizon.

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U.S. CHPC & Beverages

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Constellation Brands (STZ)	Coty Inc. (COTY)	Edgewell Personal Care Company (EPC)
Energizer Holdings, Inc (ENR)	International Flavors & Fragrances (IFF)	Kenvue Inc. (KVUE)
Keurig Dr Pepper (KDP)	Kimberly-Clark Corp. (KMB)	Molson Coors Beverage Company (TAP)
Newell Brands Inc. (NWL)	ODDITY Tech Ltd. (ODD)	Olaplex Holdings, Inc. (OLPX)
PepsiCo Inc. (PEP)	Procter & Gamble (PG)	Reynolds Consumer Products (REYN)
The Coca-Cola Company (KO)	The Estée Lauder Companies (EL)	

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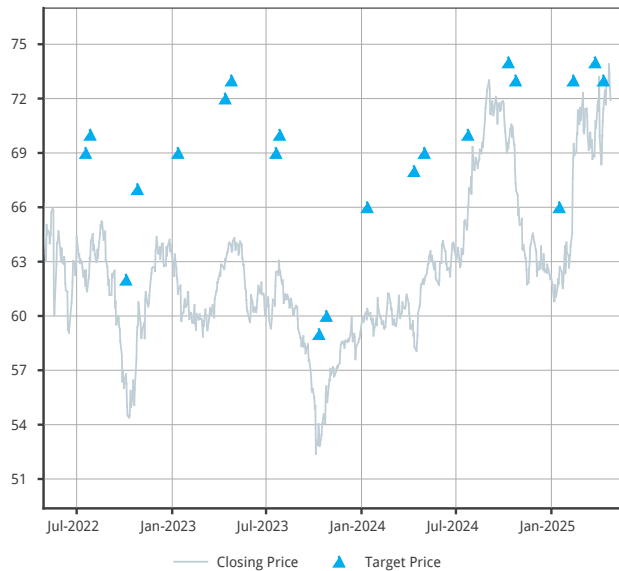
Stock Rating: **OVERWEIGHT**

Industry View: **NEUTRAL**

Closing Price: **USD 71.79** (28-Apr-2025)

Rating and Price Target Chart - USD (as of 28-Apr-2025)

Currency=USD



Source: IDC, Barclays Research

[Link to Barclays Live for interactive charting](#)

Publication Date	Closing Price*	Rating	Adjusted Price Target
11-Apr-2025	70.76		73.00
26-Mar-2025	68.95		74.00
12-Feb-2025	67.60		73.00
16-Jan-2025	61.77		66.00
24-Oct-2024	68.01		73.00
10-Oct-2024	69.57		74.00
24-Jul-2024	64.96		70.00
01-May-2024	61.77		69.00
11-Apr-2024	59.72		68.00
12-Jan-2024	59.81		66.00
25-Oct-2023	55.64		60.00
11-Oct-2023	54.03		59.00
27-Jul-2023	63.05		70.00
20-Jul-2023	61.64		69.00
25-Apr-2023	63.95		73.00
13-Apr-2023	62.69		72.00
12-Jan-2023	61.21		69.00
26-Oct-2022	58.95		67.00
04-Oct-2022	56.78		62.00
27-Jul-2022	63.21		70.00
18-Jul-2022	61.65		69.00

On 29-Apr-2022, prior to any intra-day change that may have been published, the rating for this security was Overweight, and the adjusted price target was 74.00.

Source: Bloomberg, Barclays Research

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Valuation Methodology: Our price target of \$73 is based on a ~24.9x P/E reflecting a +5% premium to the more defensive, multinational peers on our CY25 EPS estimate of \$2.94.

Risks which May Impede the Achievement of the Barclays Research Valuation and Price Target: 1) FX headwinds force downward revision of estimates, 2) Slowdown in CSD category growth, 3) More sugar taxes cloud the dialogue, 4) Deterioration in North American pricing environment would hurt results

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